Fall option 2

What we are eating

- **Lunch, Mon to Wed:** Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)
- **Lunch, Thu and Fri (and Wednesday's dinner):** Peanut tofu bowls
- **Dinner, Mon and Tue:** Vegetarian bibimbap
- **Dinner, Thu and Fri:** Kopytka (potato dumplings)
- **Breakfast:** Egg muffins **Snack:** Granola bars
- **For him only:** Plain baked chicken breast, diced: 10 portions of 100 g (about 1.3 kg raw), added to his lunches, Wednesday's dinner and the kopytka.
- **Weekend:** Polish potato salad for lunch and Tofu stir fry for dinner, both days; eggs on toast for breakfast.

The week at a glance

DAYS	BREAKFAST	LUNCH (PACKED)	SNACK	DINNER	DAY TOTAL
Mon, Tue	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 636 kcal, 43 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 484 kcal, 24 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Vegetarian bibimbap** **HIM** 4 parts 592 kcal, 29 g **HER** 3 parts 444 kcal, 21 g	**HIM 2110 kcal**, 133 g **HER 1690 kcal**, 87 g
Wed	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht)** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 slice sourdough + 100 g diced chicken 636 kcal, 43 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 slice sourdough + cottage cheese 125 g 484 kcal, 24 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 687 kcal, 53 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 511 kcal, 27 g	**HIM 2205 kcal**, 157 g **HER 1757 kcal**, 93 g
Thu, Fri	**Egg muffins** **HIM** 2 muffins + 2 slices sourdough + Greek yogurt 175 g 510 kcal, 41 g **HER** 2 muffins + 1 slice sourdough + 1 tsp butter + apple 390 kcal, 20 g	**Peanut tofu bowls** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 687 kcal, 53 g **HER** 3 parts + edamame 100 g 511 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Kopytka (potato dumplings)** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 629 kcal, 44 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 448 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2198 kcal**, 159 g **HER 1722 kcal**, 92 g
Sat	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2193 kcal**, 138 g **HER 1713 kcal**, 88 g
Sun	**Eggs on toast** **HIM** 2 eggs, 2 slices sourdough, 1 tsp butter, Greek yogurt 175 g 561 kcal, 37 g **HER** 2 eggs, 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple 406 kcal, 16 g	**Polish potato salad** **HIM** 4 parts + 100 g diced chicken 652 kcal, 48 g **HER** 3 parts + cottage cheese 125 g 465 kcal, 27 g	**Granola bars** **HIM** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g **HER** 1 bar + cottage cheese 125 g 372 kcal, 21 g	**Tofu stir fry** **HIM** 4 parts + 1 1/4 cup brown rice 608 kcal, 31 g **HER** 3 parts + 1 cup brown rice 470 kcal, 24 g	**HIM 2193 kcal**, 138 g **HER 1713 kcal**, 88 g

"4 parts" and "3 parts" are the his and hers shares of a cooked dish. Numbers are kcal and grams of protein.

The rhythm

Sunday, about 2 hours

1. Start with barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) (about 105 min). Make 1 1/4 x the recipe (5 servings).
2. Then egg muffins (about 40 min). Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins).
3. Then granola bars (25 min of work plus 2 hours chilling). Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars).
4. Bake his chicken: about 1.3 kg raw breast with salt, pepper, garlic powder and a little oil, 20 to 25 min at 425 F. Dice it and bag 10 portions of 100 g. Keep 3 in the fridge and freeze the rest, moving them down a day ahead.
5. Box the lunches for Monday to Wednesday. Peanut tofu bowls is cooked fresh on Wednesday evening.

The rest of the week

Monday	Cook vegetarian bibimbap (about 50 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Tuesday	No cooking. Leftovers from Monday.
Wednesday	Cook peanut tofu bowls (about 40 min). Eat it for dinner and box Thursday's and Friday's lunches.
Thursday	Cook Kopytka (potato dumplings) (about 40 min). Dinner tonight and tomorrow.
Friday	No cooking.
Saturday	Midday: make Polish potato salad (about 30 min) for today's and tomorrow's lunch. Evening: cook tofu stir fry (about 25 min) for tonight's and tomorrow's dinner. Breakfast both days is eggs on toast.
Sunday	Leftovers from Saturday for lunch and dinner. Afternoon: prep the next option.

Groceries used: $220.98 for both of you for the seven days ($110.49 each). Buying every pack new costs about $362.63 at the till; most of the difference stays in the pantry for later options.

Shopping list: Fall option 2

For both of you, Monday to Sunday. Save-On-Foods prices seen Nov 10, 2026. Check the fridge and pantry first: oats, rice, soy sauce, honey, peanut butter and oil last for several options.

From H Mart, not priced

Gochujang (Korean chili paste). Tofu, ginger, green onions and mushrooms are usually cheaper there too.

Pantry check (not on the list below)

Salt, pepper, neutral cooking oil, sugar or brown sugar, flour, cornstarch, vinegar, plus: thyme or rosemary, bay leaves, allspice, juniper berries, cloves, marjoram, 2 prunes, 10 dried wild mushrooms, 500 mL beet kvass, chili paste (sambal oelek), dried basil, oregano, vanilla, cinnamon, sunflower seeds, coconut flakes, sesame seeds, dried thyme (and about 325 g of the flour), garlic powder.

ITEM	NEED	BUY	PACK PRICE	COST OF AMOUNT USED
Produce				
☐ Ambrosia apple	8.62	9 x each, about 207 g	$0.91	$7.85
☐ Baby spinach (Western Family)	343 g	3 x 142 g	$4.99	$12.05
☐ Bean sprouts	120 g	1 x 227 g	$2.99	$1.58
☐ Beets, loose	500 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$3.30
☐ Broccoli	700 g	loose, by weight	$1.10/100 g	$7.70
☐ Carrots	380 g	1 x 5 lb bag	$7.99	$1.34
☐ Celery root	306 g	1 x about 355 g	$3.12	$2.69
☐ Fresh dill	0.5 bunch	1 x bunch	$3.99	$2.00
☐ Fresh ginger	25 g	loose, by weight	$0.66/100 g	$0.17
☐ Garlic	1.05 bulb	1 x 3 bulbs	$1.29	$0.45
☐ Grape tomatoes	220 g	1 x 284 g	$3.99	$3.09
☐ Green bell pepper	1	1 x each	$2.11	$2.11
☐ Green kale	1 bunch	1 x bunch	$4.49	$4.49
☐ Green onions	1.5 bunch	2 x bunch	$2.49	$3.74
☐ Leek	1.25	2 x each	$2.12	$2.65
☐ Red bell pepper	3	3 x each	$2.98	$8.94
☐ White mushrooms, loose	390 g	loose, by weight	$1.32/100 g	$5.15
☐ Yellow onions	338 g	1 x 3 lb bag	$4.99	$1.24
☐ Yellow potatoes	2.5 kg	1 x 10 lb bag	$6.99	$3.85
Meat & deli				
☐ Chicken breast, boneless skinless, warehouse pack	1.3 kg	2 x about 1.25 kg	$20.64	$21.47
Dairy & eggs				
☐ Cottage cheese 2% (Dairyland)	2.62 kg	4 x 750 g	$8.25	$28.88
☐ Extra firm tofu (Sunrise)	5.72 block	6 x 350 g	$3.99	$22.82
☐ Feta (Tre Stelle)	76 g	1 x 375 g	$8.99	$1.82
☐ Greek yogurt, plain 2% (Olympic)	1.23 kg	1 x 1.75 kg	$12.29	$8.60
☐ Large white eggs	39	3 x 18	$7.45	$16.14
☐ Salted butter (Western Family)	87 g	1 x 454 g	$6.69	$1.28
Grains & bakery				
☐ Large flake oats (Rogers)	270 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.00	$1.35
☐ Long grain brown rice (Western Family)	572 g	1 x 907 g	$3.99	$2.52
☐ Panko bread crumbs (Western Family)	25 g	1 x 227 g	$3.59	$0.40
☐ Quinoa, bulk bin	115 g	loose, by weight	$1.49/100 g	$1.71
☐ Sourdough bread, sliced (Bake Shop)	27 slice	3 x 567 g, about 12 slices	$3.99	$8.98
Pantry & cans				
☐ Canned peas (Western Family)	1 can	1 x 398 mL can	$2.59	$2.59
☐ Dijon mustard (Western Family)	5 mL	1 x 325 mL	$3.99	$0.06
☐ Extra virgin olive oil (Western Family)	64 mL	1 x 1 L	$15.99	$1.02
☐ Liquid honey (Western Family)	339 g	1 x 1 kg	$14.79	$5.01
☐ Mayonnaise (Western Family)	45 mL	1 x 890 mL	$6.99	$0.35
☐ Mini semi-sweet chocolate chips (Chipits)	90 g	1 x 270 g	$6.79	$2.26
☐ Natural smooth peanut butter (Western Family)	258 g	1 x 1 kg	$5.99	$1.54
☐ Natural whole almonds, bulk bin	202 g	loose, by weight	$1.99/100 g	$4.03
☐ Polskie ogorki dill pickles (Bick's)	4 pickles	1 x 1 L jar, about 12 pickles	$6.99	$2.33
☐ Pure sesame oil (Kosa)	85 mL	1 x 185 mL	$3.99	$1.83
☐ Rice vinegar (Marukan)	30 mL	1 x 355 mL	$5.79	$0.49
☐ Soy sauce, less sodium (Western Family)	170 mL	1 x 450 mL	$3.49	$1.32
Frozen				
☐ Frozen edamame beans (Western Family)	300 g	1 x 500 g	$2.99	$1.79
Allowance for spices, oil, vinegar and the H Mart items below (my estimate, not priced)				**$6.00**
Groceries used for this option, both of you				**$220.98**
At the till if every pack is bought new (the remainder carries into later weeks)				**$362.63**

Cook and split: Fall option 2

In cooking order. The outline is a reminder in my words; follow the linked recipe for amounts of seasoning and exact steps.

Barszcz czerwony (Polish red borscht) SUNDAY

For Mon, Tue and Wed lunches · Make 1 1/4 x the recipe (5 servings) · about 105 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-red-borscht-vegan (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	500 g beets, loose; 200 g carrots; 306 g celery root; 275 g white mushrooms, loose; 1.25 leek; 188 g yellow onions; 0.25 bulb garlic; 0.62 ambrosia apple; 19 mL extra virgin olive oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Roast beets, carrots, root vegetables, mushrooms, leek, onion, garlic and herbs at 425 F until golden, 30 to 40 min. 2. Deglaze the pan, then simmer everything with water, bay, allspice, juniper, cloves, a prune or two and dried mushrooms. 3. Strain, then stir in the beet kvass and marjoram; season to taste.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Mon, Tue and Wed lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.95 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.71.
SIDES	Him: 1 slice sourdough. Her: 1 slice sourdough, cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	Up to 7 days in the fridge in a lidded container (author).
REHEAT	Reheat gently, 2 min in the microwave; do not boil it hard or the colour dulls.
ALLERGENS	None of the major allergens (sulphites if you use the wine)
NOTE	Polish barszcz czerwony, the clear beet broth, not the chunky Ukrainian soup. It needs about 500 mL of beet kvass (zakwas), a few dried wild mushrooms and 2 prunes, none of which are costed: a Polish deli sells kvass, or the author links her own 5 day recipe. It is a light soup, so it is paired with bread and something more filling.

Egg muffins SUNDAY

For breakfasts, Mon to Fri · Make 2 x the recipe (24 muffins) · about 40 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-breakfast-egg-muffins (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	60 g baby spinach; 1 red bell pepper; 1 green bell pepper; 220 g grape tomatoes; 20 large white eggs; 76 g feta. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Divide spinach, peppers and tomatoes among greased muffin cups. 2. Whisk eggs, whites and seasoning; pour over and top with feta. 3. Bake at 350 F about 25 min.
SPLIT	Each weekday: 2 muffins for him, 2 muffins for her. 4 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: 2 slices sourdough, Greek yogurt 175 g. Her: 1 slice sourdough, 1 tsp butter, apple.
KEEP	3 days in the fridge, 3 months in the freezer (author). Freeze Thursday's and Friday's.
REHEAT	Microwave 30 to 45 s from the fridge, about 60 s from frozen.
ALLERGENS	Eggs, milk (feta)
NOTE	The tomatoes are baked in. To keep his completely tomato-free, leave them out of half the cups.

Granola bars SUNDAY

For snacks, Mon to Fri · Make 1 1/2 x the recipe (15 bars) · about 135 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/healthy-granola-bars (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	270 g large flake oats; 202 g natural whole almonds, bulk bin; 255 g liquid honey; 128 g natural smooth peanut butter; 90 g mini semi-sweet chocolate chips. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Toast oats, nuts and seeds. 2. Warm honey with peanut butter, stir in vanilla, cinnamon and the toasted mix; fold in chips. 3. Press firmly into a lined pan, chill 2 hours, cut into 10.
SPLIT	Every day including the weekend: 1 bar for him, 1 bar for her. 1 left over for the weekend or the freezer.
SIDES	Him: cottage cheese 125 g. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	1 week at room temperature, 2 weeks in the fridge, 2 months frozen (author).
REHEAT	Eat as is.
ALLERGENS	Peanuts, tree nuts; chocolate chips usually contain milk and soy

Vegetarian bibimbap MONDAY EVENING

For Mon and Tue dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 50 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/vegetarian-bibimbap (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	1.15 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 42 g liquid honey; 45 mL pure sesame oil; 1 bunch green kale; 120 g bean sprouts; 0.4 bulb garlic; 15 mL extra virgin olive oil; 0.5 bunch green onions; 115 g white mushrooms, loose; 180 g carrots; 4 large white eggs; 115 g quinoa, bulk bin. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Crisp the tofu. 2. Blanch the kale and bean sprouts separately and dress each with soy and sesame oil. 3. Saute the mushrooms, then the carrot matchsticks. 4. Fry the eggs. Build bowls over quinoa and top with the gochujang sauce.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Mon and Tue dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: nothing extra.
KEEP	Vegetables and tofu keep up to 2 days (author), which is why this is a Monday and Tuesday dinner.
REHEAT	Rewarm the vegetables and tofu in a pan; fry the eggs fresh.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame, eggs
H MART	Gochujang (Korean chili paste)
HEAT	The gochujang sauce goes on top, not in the dish: a small dab for her, a full spoon for him.
NOTE	Meatless. Costed with white mushrooms in place of shiitake.

Peanut tofu bowls WEDNESDAY EVENING

For Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: pinchofyum.com/spicy-peanut-tofu-bowls (Pinch of Yum)

BUY FOR IT	2.3 block extra firm tofu; 30 mL extra virgin olive oil; 700 g broccoli; 2 red bell pepper; 280 g long grain brown rice; 130 g natural smooth peanut butter; 80 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 30 mL pure sesame oil; 30 mL rice vinegar; 42 g liquid honey; 10 g fresh ginger; 0.1 bulb garlic. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Press and cube the tofu, toss with cornstarch, and roast it on a sheet pan with the broccoli and pepper strips. 2. Cook the rice. 3. Blend peanut butter, soy, sesame oil, vinegar, chili paste, sweetener, ginger, garlic and water into a sauce. 4. Bowl up rice, tofu and vegetables; drizzle with sauce.
SPLIT	Set 1 serving aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 3 his-and-hers pairs (Wed dinner, Thu and Fri lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 0.95 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.71.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: edamame 100 g.
KEEP	The author says the leftovers suit meal prep and that it freezes. Fridge life of 4 days is my guidance.
REHEAT	Microwave 90 s; add the peanut sauce after.
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), peanuts, sesame
HEAT	The heat is only the chili paste in the peanut sauce. Leave it out of the blender; he adds sambal to his own bowl.
NOTE	Costed with brown rice in place of white.

Kopytka (potato dumplings) THURSDAY EVENING

For Thu and Fri dinners · Make the recipe once (8 servings) · about 40 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-kopytka-dumplings (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1 kg yellow potatoes; 2 large white eggs; 42 g salted butter; 25 g panko bread crumbs. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes in their skins, peel, mash or rice them and cool. 2. Knead quickly with flour, eggs and salt. 3. Roll into thumb-thick ropes and cut into small diagonal pieces. 4. Boil in salted water until they float; top with butter-toasted breadcrumbs.
SPLIT	Set 3 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Thu and Fri dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.4 of the recipe's servings, hers about 1.1.
SIDES	Him: 100 g diced chicken. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page gives no storage time; the author says to reheat by frying or in the microwave. My guidance: 3 days in the fridge; freeze the spare dumplings on a tray.
REHEAT	Fry gently in a little butter (author's preference), or microwave 60 to 90 s.
ALLERGENS	Wheat, eggs, milk (butter)
NOTE	You also need about 325 g of flour from the pantry. The recipe makes 8 servings: this plan eats 5 over two nights and freezes 3.

Polish potato salad SATURDAY MIDDAY

For Saturday and Sunday lunches · Make the recipe once (6 servings) · about 30 min · full recipe: polonist.com/polish-potato-salad (Polonist)

BUY FOR IT	1.5 kg yellow potatoes; 5 large white eggs; 150 g yellow onions; 4 pickles polskie ogorki dill pickles; 1 can canned peas; 1 ambrosia apple; 45 mL mayonnaise; 5 mL dijon mustard; 0.5 bunch fresh dill. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Boil the potatoes and the eggs; cool and cube both. 2. Chop the pickles and onion finely; cube the apple. 3. Fold everything with the drained peas, mayonnaise, mustard and plenty of dill.
SPLIT	Set 2 servings aside first for the freezer or the weekend. Divide the rest into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday lunches). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: nothing extra. Her: cottage cheese 125 g.
KEEP	The page only says to keep it refrigerated. My guidance: 3 days.
REHEAT	Eat cold.
ALLERGENS	Eggs, mustard
NOTE	Polish salatka with apple and peas. Costed with Bick's Polskie ogorki; a Polish deli's kiszone are closer to what the author means.

Tofu stir fry SATURDAY EVENING

For Saturday and Sunday dinners · Make the recipe once (4 servings) · about 25 min · full recipe: wellplated.com/tofu-stir-fry (Well Plated)

BUY FOR IT	2.27 block extra firm tofu; 45 mL soy sauce, less sodium; 0.3 bulb garlic; 1 bunch green onions; 15 g fresh ginger; 283 g baby spinach; 10 mL pure sesame oil. Seasonings and exact amounts are on the recipe page.
OUTLINE	1. Dry and cube the tofu; fry it in hot oil until golden, seasoning with soy. 2. Add garlic, scallions, ginger and chili paste. 3. Wilt in the spinach by the handful; finish with sesame seeds and sesame oil.
SPLIT	Divide the whole batch into 2 his-and-hers pairs (Saturday and Sunday dinners). Fill his 4 parts to her 3: his is about 1.1 of the recipe's servings, hers about 0.86.
SIDES	Him: 1 1/4 cup brown rice. Her: 1 cup brown rice.
KEEP	Up to 5 days in the fridge (author).
REHEAT	Microwave gently, 60 to 90 s (author).
ALLERGENS	Soy, wheat (soy sauce), sesame
HEAT	Leave the chili paste out of the pan; he adds it at the table.
NOTE	Meatless.